



Integral USB 2.0 Flash Drive

About Average...

Integral's (1 GB) USB 2.0 Flash Drive is encased in a flashy sky-blue rubber exterior. This means it's not only rugged enough to be reasonably shock-proof, it's also splash-proof. One problem: the rubber coating tends to attract dust.

Performance was slow compared to that of other 1 GB Flash drives. Writing 700 MB of assorted data to the drive took 5 minutes, and

reading the same data from the drive took a minute. (As a comparison, the Corsair Flash Voyager 1 GB, which is similarly rugged, writes 700 MB to the drive in 34 per cent of the time we've mentioned, and reading takes 37 per cent of the time.) Random access time, though, was 5.2 ms, which is quite good.

The drive comes with SecretZip, a compression software that compresses data with password

protection. SecretZip can only be run on Integral's USB Flash drives.

this drive, else there are better-performing products

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Contact: Goldstone Imaging Pvt. Ltd
Phone: 011-41530501
E-mail: integral@goldstoneltd.com
Web site: www.integralmemory.com
Price: Rs 1,550

But that's just about as much security as the software provides: the compressed files can be easily deleted... If ruggedness is of prime importance, you'll like

available at better prices.

Specifications

USB 2.0; software bundle: SecretZip

XFX nFORCE 680i LT

680i On A Diet

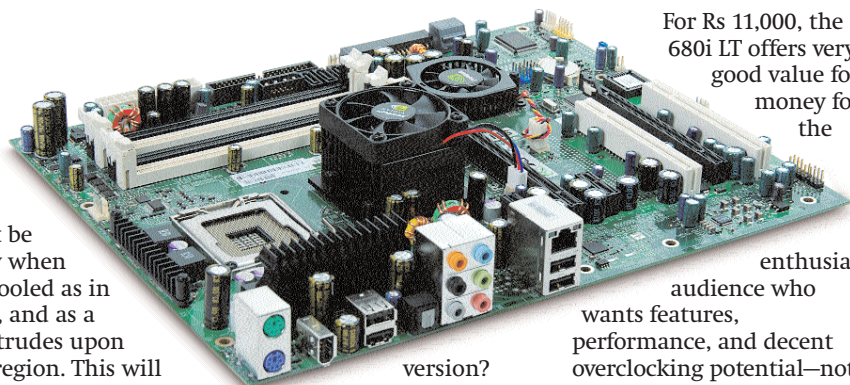
Let's face it... Sure nFORCE 680i motherboards are blazing performers, feature-rich, and future proof (read 1333 MHz FSB support), but they aren't exactly wallet-friendly! Neither is the nFORCE 650i a very viable option for enthusiasts. NVIDIA finally acknowledges this and coughs up a "budget" variant of their top-end 680i, with the "LT" as a suffix.

XFX's 680i LT uses the reference NVIDIA PCB layout, which is now designated "Designed for NVIDIA." One major annoyance: the power pins are squeezed between the memory modules, the four pin auxiliary power connector, and the IDE connector. This makes accessing the pins extremely difficult, and it's not a good idea to have wires around the memory slots either. XFX has provided cooling fans for both chipsets; however, the Northbridge

heatsink is quite large (which shouldn't be necessary when actively cooled as in this case), and as a result, intrudes upon the CPU region. This will probably preclude installation of larger coolers like Thermalright's XP-120 and Ultra 120, or Scythe's Ninja and Infinity coolers.

The BIOS on this board is the same as a regular 680i, minus a few SLI memory profiles, and some extra options like a PCI-Express slot (the 680i has three, while the LT version has two).

So what's different between the 680i and its LT



For Rs 11,000, the 680i LT offers very good value for money for the

enthusiast audience who

wants features, performance, and decent overclocking potential—not to mention SLI. In fact, if you don't plan on a physics card and two 1 Gbps LAN connects, you can overlook the 680i altogether and pick a board based on the 680i LT chipset. Hardcore overclockers will still look at the 680i and Intel's P965, while casual users will settle for lower solutions like NVIDIA's 650i and Intel's 965G, which are slightly lower-performing options and sans a few features.

version?

Three main things. First, there's no third PCI-Express slot between the two SLI x16 slots. Second, there's one Gigabit LAN instead of two, making NVIDIA's DualNet impossible. And third, SLI profiles are only supported up to 800 MHz (the 680i goes up to 1200 MHz). What you get in exchange is a much lower price tag, taking the 680i LT well and truly into Intel's P965 territory price-wise.

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Bundle	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Overall	★★★★

Contact: Rashi Peripherals Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-67090909
E-mail: navinderc@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.xfxforce.com
Price: Rs 12,500

Specifications

nFORCE 680i LT chipset, Socket 775, Core 2 Duo/Quad ready, 1066/1333 FSB, DDR2 800 MHz support, six SATA 2.0 ports, eight USB 2.0 ports